

Employee Policy Handbook

[Company Name]

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Contents

Purpose, Scope & Employment Basics	2
Code of Conduct & Ethics	3
Working Hours, Attendance & Remote Work	4
Leave Policy	5
Compensation, Benefits & Expenses	6
Equal Opportunity, Anti-Harassment & Grievances	7
Information Security & Data Privacy	8
Acceptable Use of Company Resources	9
Performance, Discipline, Separation & Acknowledgment	10

This is a template policy. Replace bracketed placeholders and align figures with local labour law and your organisation's practice before issuing it to employees.

2. Purpose, Scope & Employment Basics

2.1 Purpose

This handbook sets out the standards, expectations and entitlements that apply to everyone who works at [Company Name]. It exists so that employees know what the company expects of them and what they can expect in return, and so that decisions are made consistently and fairly.

2.2 Scope

These policies apply to all full-time, part-time and fixed-term employees, interns and trainees. Contractors and consultants are covered by their contracts, but must follow the conduct, security and confidentiality sections while working with company systems or data.

2.3 Employment categories

Category	Description
Full-time	Works the standard schedule (about 40 hours a week) and is eligible for all benefits.
Part-time	Works fewer than standard hours; benefits are applied pro rata.
Fixed-term	Hired for a defined period or project; benefits follow the contract.
Intern / trainee	Time-limited learning engagement; stipend and benefits as stated in the offer letter.

2.4 Onboarding and probation

New employees complete an induction covering policies, security awareness and role objectives within their first two weeks. A probation period of three to six months applies, as stated in the offer letter. Performance is reviewed at the midpoint and end of probation, and either party may end employment with the notice stated in the contract.

2.5 Changes to this handbook

The company may update these policies from time to time. Material changes will be communicated in writing, and the current version on the intranet is always the one that applies. Where a policy conflicts with applicable law or an individual contract, the law or contract prevails.

3. Code of Conduct & Ethics

3.1 Core principles

Employees are expected to act with honesty, respect and accountability in every interaction with colleagues, customers, partners and the public.

- Treat everyone with courtesy and dignity, whether in person, in writing or online.
- Be truthful in records, reports, timesheets, expense claims and communications.
- Take responsibility for your work, raise problems early and own mistakes.
- Comply with all laws, regulations and company policies that apply to your role.
- Protect the company's reputation, assets and confidential information.

3.2 Conflicts of interest

A conflict of interest arises when a personal interest could influence, or appear to influence, your judgement at work. Employees must disclose to their manager and HR, in writing, any of the following:

- Financial interests in a competitor, supplier or customer.
- Outside employment, consulting or business activity that overlaps with company work or hours.
- Hiring or supervising a relative or close personal partner.
- Board or advisory roles with other organisations.

3.3 Gifts and hospitality

Gifts or hospitality may not be solicited. Items of modest value (under [amount]) offered as a courtesy may be accepted and should be logged with your manager. Anything larger, any cash or equivalent, and anything offered during a tender or negotiation must be declined or reported to HR.

3.4 Anti-bribery and corruption

The company prohibits offering, paying, requesting or accepting bribes or facilitation payments in any form, directly or through third parties.

3.5 Speaking up

Employees who suspect misconduct, fraud, safety risks or breaches of policy are encouraged to report them to their manager, HR or the confidential channel at [ethics@company.com]. Good-faith reports are protected, and retaliation against anyone who raises a concern is itself a disciplinary matter.

4. Working Hours, Attendance & Remote Work

4.1 Standard hours

The standard working week is Monday to Friday, 9:30 AM to 6:30 PM, including a one-hour unpaid lunch break. Teams may agree flexible start and finish times, provided core hours of 11:00 AM to 4:00 PM are covered and business needs are met.

4.2 Attendance and punctuality

- Notify your manager as early as possible if you will be late or absent, and no later than the start of your shift.
- Absences of more than three consecutive days due to illness may require a medical certificate.
- Repeated unexplained absence or lateness may lead to disciplinary action.
- Record time and attendance accurately in the HR system.

4.3 Overtime

Overtime must be approved in advance by a manager. Eligible employees receive overtime pay or time off in lieu in line with local law and their contract. Salaried managerial roles are generally not eligible for overtime.

4.4 Hybrid and remote work

Where a role allows, employees may work remotely under a hybrid arrangement agreed with their manager. The following apply:

Topic	Expectation
Availability	Be reachable on agreed channels during working hours and attend scheduled meetings.
Workspace	Maintain a safe, quiet space with a reliable internet connection.
Security	Use company devices and the VPN; never work on confidential data in public spaces.
In-office days	Attend the office on team anchor days, currently [two] days per week.
Review	Arrangements may be changed or withdrawn if performance or business needs require it.

4.5 Public holidays

The company publishes its list of paid public holidays each December for the following year. Employees required to work on a holiday receive a compensatory day off or additional pay.

5. Leave Policy

Leave entitlements below are for full-time employees per calendar year and are pro-rated for part-time staff and for joining or leaving mid-year. They represent a template and should be checked against local statute.

Leave type	Entitlement	Key conditions
Annual / paid leave	18 days	Apply at least 5 working days ahead; manager approval required.
Sick leave	10 days	Notify on day one; certificate after 3 consecutive days.
Casual leave	6 days	For urgent personal matters; short notice allowed.
Maternity leave	26 weeks	Per applicable law; notice of at least 8 weeks where possible.
Paternity leave	2 weeks	To be taken within 6 months of the birth or adoption.
Bereavement leave	5 days	For immediate family; discretionary for others.
Marriage leave	3 days	Once during employment, with supporting notice.
Unpaid leave	Up to 30 days	Subject to approval, business needs and reason.

5.1 Applying for leave

Submit requests through the HR system. Managers aim to respond within two working days. Approval depends on team coverage and workload; during peak periods the company may limit concurrent leave.

5.2 Carry-forward and encashment

Up to 5 days of unused annual leave may be carried into the next year and must be used by 31 March. Unused leave beyond that lapses unless local law provides otherwise. Eligible balances are settled on exit according to statute.

5.3 Sick leave and wellbeing

Employees should stay home when unwell. The company supports phased returns to work after long illness and will consider reasonable adjustments for health conditions and disabilities. Medical information is handled in confidence.

5.4 Leave during notice period

Leave during a notice period requires manager approval and may be declined where handover is at risk.

6. Compensation, Benefits & Expenses

6.1 Pay

Salaries are paid monthly, in arrears, on or before the last working day of the month by bank transfer. Pay is set according to role, experience, market data and internal equity, and is reviewed annually alongside the performance cycle. Statutory deductions, including tax and social contributions, are applied as required, and a payslip is issued each month.

6.2 Benefits

Benefit	Summary
Health insurance	Group medical cover for the employee, spouse and dependent children from the first day.
Life and accident cover	Group term life and personal accident insurance at no cost to the employee.
Retirement	Statutory provident fund or pension contributions; optional company match of up to [x]%.
Learning budget	Annual allowance of [amount] for courses, books and certifications related to the role.
Wellness	Employee assistance programme, counselling access and wellness reimbursements.
Bonus	Discretionary annual or variable pay linked to company and individual performance.

6.3 Business travel and expenses

Reasonable, pre-approved expenses incurred for company business are reimbursed. To claim:

- Obtain manager approval before booking travel or incurring significant costs.
- Submit claims within 30 days with original receipts and a business purpose.
- Book economy travel and standard accommodation unless otherwise approved.
- Personal, alcohol-only, fines and non-business expenses are not reimbursable.

6.4 Payroll errors

Employees should report suspected payroll errors to HR promptly. Overpayments will be recovered in line with local law, and underpayments corrected in the next pay run.

7. Equal Opportunity, Anti-Harassment & Grievances

7.1 Equal opportunity

[Company Name] is committed to a workplace free from discrimination. Employment decisions, including hiring, pay, promotion, training and termination, are made on merit and without regard to race, colour, religion, caste, sex, gender identity, sexual orientation, age, disability, marital status, pregnancy, national origin or any other protected characteristic.

7.2 Harassment and bullying

Harassment of any kind is unacceptable, whether it occurs in the office, remotely, at events or online. Examples include:

- Unwelcome sexual advances, comments, gestures or requests for favours.
- Offensive jokes, slurs, images or messages based on a protected characteristic.
- Intimidation, humiliation, exclusion or abuse of authority.
- Retaliation against anyone who reports or participates in an investigation.

7.3 Prevention of sexual harassment

The company maintains an Internal Committee in line with applicable legislation. Its members and contact details are published on the intranet. Complaints may be made in writing or verbally within the timeframe set by law.

7.4 Raising a grievance

Step	What happens
1. Informal	Raise the matter with your manager or HR partner; many issues are resolved here.
2. Formal	Submit a written grievance to HR, who acknowledge it within 3 working days.
3. Investigation	A fair, impartial and confidential investigation is completed, usually within 30 days.
4. Outcome	The employee is told the outcome and any action; they may appeal to a senior leader.

7.5 Reasonable adjustments

Employees who need adjustments to their role, equipment or schedule because of disability, health or religious practice should speak with HR. The company will consider all reasonable requests.

8. Information Security & Data Privacy

8.1 Confidential information

Employees handle sensitive information, including customer data, source code, financials, strategies and personal data about colleagues. This information must be used only for company purposes and shared only with those who have a legitimate need. Confidentiality obligations continue after employment ends.

8.2 Security responsibilities

- Use strong, unique passwords and multi-factor authentication on all work accounts.
- Lock your screen whenever you step away; never share credentials.
- Keep devices, browsers and applications updated; install only approved software.
- Do not store company data on personal devices, personal email or unapproved cloud services.
- Be alert to phishing; report suspicious emails to [security@company.com] immediately.
- Encrypt laptops and removable media that hold company data.

8.3 Data classification

Level	Examples	Handling
Public	Marketing material, published pricing	No restrictions.
Internal	Policies, org charts, project plans	Share inside the company only.
Confidential	Customer data, contracts, source code	Need-to-know; approved tools; encrypted.
Restricted	Credentials, health or financial records	Strict access control and logging.

8.4 Personal data and privacy

Personal data must be collected, used and stored lawfully, for a stated purpose, and kept only as long as needed. Employees must follow the company's privacy notice and applicable data-protection laws.

8.5 Reporting incidents

Any suspected loss, theft or exposure of data or devices must be reported to the security team within 24 hours. Prompt reporting limits harm, and good-faith reports will not be penalised.

9. Acceptable Use of Company Resources

9.1 Equipment and systems

Company laptops, phones, networks, email, collaboration tools and accounts are provided for business use. Limited, reasonable personal use is acceptable if it does not interfere with work, create security risk or breach policy. Users should have no expectation of privacy on company systems, which may be monitored as permitted by law for security and compliance.

9.2 Prohibited activities

- Accessing, storing or sending illegal, offensive, discriminatory or sexually explicit material.
- Installing pirated or unlicensed software, or bypassing security controls.
- Using company resources for personal commercial gain or outside business ventures.
- Unauthorised copying, forwarding or uploading of company data.
- Excessive streaming, gaming or other use that degrades network performance.

9.3 Use of AI tools

Approved generative AI tools may be used to improve productivity. Employees must not enter confidential, personal or customer data into unapproved AI services, and remain responsible for verifying the accuracy of any AI-assisted output they use or share.

9.4 Social media and public communication

Personal social media is your own, but you must make clear that views are personal, never disclose confidential information, and avoid content that harasses colleagues or harms the company's reputation. Only authorised spokespeople may speak to the media on the company's behalf.

9.5 Intellectual property

Work created in the course of employment, including code, designs, documents and inventions, belongs to the company, as set out in the employment contract. Employees must respect third-party licences and copyrights.

9.6 Return of property

All equipment, access cards, documents and data must be returned on or before the last working day.

10. Performance, Discipline, Separation & Acknowledgment

10.1 Performance management

Employees agree goals with their manager each cycle, receive regular feedback and take part in at least one formal review a year. Where performance falls short, a documented improvement plan with clear targets and support will normally be offered first.

10.2 Disciplinary process

Misconduct is handled fairly and proportionately. Depending on severity, outcomes include a verbal warning, written warning, final warning, suspension, demotion or dismissal. Employees have the right to be told the allegations, to respond, and to appeal. Gross misconduct, such as theft, fraud, violence, serious harassment or serious data breach, may result in summary dismissal.

10.3 Resignation and termination

- Notice period is as stated in the contract, typically 30 to 90 days.
- A handover plan and exit interview are completed before the last day.
- Final settlement, including salary and eligible leave balance, is paid per statutory timelines.
- An experience letter is issued after clearance of dues and return of property.

10.4 Questions and contacts

For questions about this handbook, contact HR at [hr@company.com].

Employee acknowledgment

I confirm that I have received, read and understood the Employee Policy Handbook, and I agree to comply with its provisions. I understand that it does not form a contract of employment and may be updated by the company.

Employee name:	_____	Signature:	_____
Employee ID:	_____	Date:	_____
HR representative:	_____	Date:	_____